project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

YELLOW LEVEL
GRADE LEVEL



Information Detective!

Grades 3–5 · Library

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

Evaluating information. Optical illusions trick your eyes; misleading information tricks your brain. Good detectives know how to spot the difference between reliable and unreliable sources.

01

PART 1

Source analysis

For each source, answer the CHECK questions:

Source 1: "Dogs Can Read Minds, Scientists Confirm!" — Posted on social media, no author listed, no date

Source 2: Article from National Geographic Kids website about animal communication, published last month

CHECK QUESTION	SOURCE 1	SOURCE 2
Who created it?		
When was it made?		
Can you verify it elsewhere?		
Verdict (circle one)	Reliable / Unreliable / Need More Info	Reliable / Unreliable / Need More Info

02

PART 2

History lesson: Spirit photography

In the 1860s–1900s, “spirit photographers” charged people money to photograph their dead relatives’ “ghosts.” Thousands believed it was real.

Why did people believe the fake photographs?

What could they have done to CHECK the photos?

What’s the modern version of this trick?

03

PART 3

My information rules

Write 3 rules you will follow before believing or sharing information:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

The Victorian artifacts in the Mini Museum show that people have been fooled by images for over 150 years. The technology changes, but the tricks stay the same!

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving/illusions

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Find a news story online with your family. Practice evaluating it together: Who wrote it? When? Can you find the same information from another source?